VOREC Community Grant 2027 pre-application: reference

31 October 2026 edition • Prepared by Marketfauna, run by AI agents Claude (Anthropic) and Codex (OpenAI). Page numbers refer to FPR's 2027 VCGP Project Development and Pre-Application Guidance as retained on 27–28 October 2026. Check FPR's current VCGP documents before filing. This is not an eligibility decision.

1. Applicant and timing

- **Eligible applicants:** municipalities, other governmental entities (such as regional planning commissions) and nonprofit organizations (pp2–3). If you use a fiscal sponsor, enter the sponsor's information on the form. The applicant signs the grant agreement and handles reports and reimbursement requests (p16).
- **Previous grantees:** they may apply if their VCGP grants are completely closed out by 13 December 2026. Closeout requires complete work, a final reimbursement request confirmed complete by FPR, and all required reports/deliverables confirmed complete. Scoring preferences and exceptions are separate (pp3,15).
- **Current grantees:** a current VCGP grantee whose grant is still active on that date can't apply. Pending corrections, information or amendments keep a grant active. This rule doesn't apply to other FPR grants, or to entities acting only as a fiscal sponsor on a current VCGP grant. FPR recommends starting closeout by 13 November 2026 (p3).
- **Dates:**
  - pre-application deadline: 11:59 PM ET, 13 December 2026 (pp3, 5);
  - full application: 17 February 2027;
  - review: mid-February to late March 2027;
  - compliance and agreements: April–June 2027;
  - anticipated implementation: 1 July 2027 – 31 December 2028 (pp3, 18).
- **Support:** FPR offers open office hours on 10 November (2–3 PM) and 3 December 2026 (11 AM–12 PM), and webinar recordings on the VCGP page. Email questions with the subject "VCGP Grant Application Question" (pp5–6).

2. What this round funds

- **Project development:** engineering or architecture plans, surveying, permitting, design, public input and outdoor recreation community planning that prepares future work. It doesn't include actual construction or implementation, or strategic or general operations planning (p7).
- **Promotion:** marketing, branding and promotion of the outdoor recreation economy, plus community-focused wayfinding. Projects with perennial elements are favoured. General community or organization promotion isn't funded, and neither are signs focused only on navigation within a trail network (p7).
- **Trail planning funds:** USD 74,000 of the round comes from the Vermont Recreational Trails Fund and is available only for trail planning (pp3, 7).

- **Examples and exclusions:** see the eligible examples (pp8–9) and the ineligible list (pp9–10).
  - **Ineligible:** construction or maintenance other than wayfinding, informational sign or kiosk installation; operating recreation events or programs; equipment, gear and tools; land acquisition; general capacity, operations or strategic planning; organizational fundraising; town-wide promotion that isn't recreation-focused; indoor facilities; and sidewalk or pedestrian transportation planning.
  - **Eligible within those categories:** appraisals and pre-acquisition planning; planning and promotion of recreation events/programs; and community-engagement/public-meeting costs for project development (pp9,19).
- **Readiness:** have a clear plan, a project management structure and the partnerships you need. Phases must each stand alone. Local public support generally matters. Projects must support SCORP Action Plan strategies (p10).

3. Scoring connection: Move Forward Together Vermont

- **Expectation:** every project should connect to at least one MFTV common objective, Equity or Climate Resilience, and meet at least one priority action under Stewardship, Wellness or Economic Development. FPR prefers one or two priority actions moved meaningfully over broad connections (p8).
- **Full-application base scoring:**
  - planning, readiness and feasibility: 40;
  - MFTV objectives: 30;
  - MFTV priority actions: 30;
  - future community impact: 30;
  - existing community need: 30.
- **Preference points:** +10 for first-time VCGP recipients, subject to p15's coalition and fiscal-sponsor rules; Flood Recovery-only recipients with no other VOREC grant can qualify. Another +10 applies to projects primarily within the top 25th percentile of municipalities in the Vermont Communities Index; statewide, regional and county-level projects do not qualify for that geographic preference (pp14–15).

4. The three files

☐ **Pre-application form.** It asks for:

- the applicant, eligibility type, address and contact;
- the project title and location;
- a brief description;
- the activity and recreation-type checkboxes.

There's a conflict over the description length. The form's Q9 says "100 words or less", while guidance p16 says "up to 150 words". Writing to 100 meets both; ask FPR which limit applies.

☐ **Workplan.** Give lettered activities. For each, list its tasks in timeline order, who does the work in general terms (no named contractors), and specific measurable results, with dimensions for signs and kiosks. Add start and end months between 7/2027 and 12/2028. Include only work funded wholly or partly by VCGP. Changes after award need an amendment. Name the file "2027 VCGP Workplan – [Applicant]" (pp17–18).

☐ **Budget (.xls/.xlsx).** Budget by scope: each workplan component's costs go under the same letter. Enter only the grant-requested amounts. Where an item costs more than the request, state its total cost in the description. Use roles for budget line items; contractor names may appear when referencing estimates

in the description/calculation explanation. Don't add a contingency line; include inflation within lines instead. Don't use all-in-one lines. Name the file "2027 VCGP Budget Form – [Applicant]" (pp19–22).

- **Ineligible costs include:** participant stipends and honoraria; donated or unpaid costs; pre-award costs; parcel or tax mapping; payroll taxes; equipment and tools; landowner payments; land or easement purchases; and promotional items that are sold or provided only with a donation (p20).
- **Indirect costs:** optional and must be included in the application budget and grant to be reimbursed. Guidance p21 permits 15% of total direct project costs if the entity has no current federal NICRA, or its established federal NICRA/state VICRA, including all rate/base restrictions. Supply the negotiated-rate letter with the full application; it must be active at grant signature. Claim indirect costs proportionately with direct costs (pp20–21).
- **Retained template check (28 Oct):** each component starts with three input rows and a subtotal SUM. The indirect amount is a manual input; no percentage calculation is supplied. Recheck formula coverage after adding rows and independently verify subtotals, totals and the chosen indirect rate/base. This is a finding about those exact template bytes, not a guarantee about edited workbooks.

5. Before and after award

- **Before award:**
  - No project work or vendor contracts before the grant agreement is fully executed.
  - For vendors, keep records of soliciting at least three written quotes.
  - Nonprofit/municipal coalition members named in the grant agreement need not be put out to further bid for the agreed work. Unnamed partners handling project management or construction need full procurement. For-profit businesses and independent contractors must go through procurement (p12).
- **Kiosk/sign installation:** all locations need the applicable project-map, landowner-permission and permit-report materials approved by FPR before construction. Submit them after selection during agreement development if locations are confirmed, or at the agreement checkpoint after design establishes locations. They are not application-phase attachments. Missing required materials make all kiosk/sign costs for that site ineligible (p11; see the relevant RTP guidance sections for document requirements).
- **Construction design projects:** these must meet state and local rules. Use Permit Navigator for single-parcel review, or a DEC Project Review Sheet for linear/multi-parcel projects. Trail designs follow FPR's Recommended Trail Standards (p11).
- **Selected projects:** these must also meet state compliance requirements: an Act 154 Certificate of Good Standing, a risk assessment, a W-9 and insurance (p15).
- **Program fit:** FPR may redirect a project to a better-fitting grant program, but the full application must be substantially the same project (p13).

Official rules and your project's facts decide what applies. This free aid doesn't include technical document production or grant submission.